

Internship Report

**ONSITE INTERNSHIP
ASKARI BANK (IT HUB)**

**Submitted By
Maheen Tokir
FA23-BCS-041
IT OPERATIONS INTERN
Winter 2026
03-03-2026**



COMSATS University Islamabad, Abbottabad Campus

Declaration Form

I, **Maheen Tokir**, Registration No. **FA23-BCS-041**, enrolled in the **BS Computer Science** hereby declare that I have successfully completed an on-site internship of 6 weeks through Askari bank IT HUB. This report has been prepared based on the tasks and experiences gained during the internship period. The internship was carried out under the supervision of External Supervisor Sir Raja Kashif Siddique and Faculty Advisor Sir Mukhtiar Zamin. I affirm that this report is original work and has not been submitted elsewhere for academic credit.

Student: Maheen Tokir

Signature:_____

1. Acknowledgement

I am sincerely thankful to Almighty Allah for giving me the strength and opportunity to complete my internship successfully.

I would like to express my gratitude to the IT Department and all the staff members who guided and supported me throughout my internship. Their cooperation and professional advice helped me gain practical knowledge and understand real world working environments.

I am also thankful to my university supervisor and instructors for their guidance and encouragement during this period. Lastly, I deeply appreciate my family for their continuous support and motivation, which helped me complete both my internship and this report successfully.

2. Executive summary

This report describes my internship experience in the IT Hub of the Askari Bank in which I could get an on-the-job exposure to the IT infrastructure and operations within the Bank at the enterprise level. The internship has helped me in knowing how a financial institution organizes and regulates its hardware, software, network systems as well as security controls.

In the course of training, I learned the working process of domain-based networks, branch accessibility, and unified IT management. I made observations and helped with software installation, configuration of the system, hardware troubleshooting as well as management of domain users. I also got to know how the IT infrastructure is implemented at various branches and how the backup checking is done to maintain the same data and business continuity.

Besides the infrastructure management, I also had an understanding as to how security occurrences and attempted access are detected and managed using multiple layers of security. I designed a front-end Web Site with the use of basic till advanced features, created a Software Requirements Specification (SRS) document, and worked on the analytical scenarios in Excel by using formulas, pivot tables, conditional formatting, and dashboards as part of my weekly assignments. I also set up proper email addresses with the help of Microsoft Outlook as part of enterprise communications.

On the whole, this internship helped to enhance my technical background on the topic of banking IT systems, as well as to become more skilled in analytical thinking, documentation and confidence in my work in a real setting.

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3. Introduction to Onsite Internship

3.1 Importance of Onsite Internships

Onsite internships play a critical role in professional development, particularly in fields such as IT infrastructure and cyber-security where real-time system monitoring, hardware handling, and network administration are essential. Unlike simulated academic environments, onsite internships provide direct exposure to enterprise systems, operational workflows, and organizational security practices.

Working physically within an IT department allows interns to observe how infrastructure is managed, how technical issues are resolved under time constraints, and how coordination takes place between different operational units. It also helps develop professional behavior, workplace communication skills, technical documentation practices, and problem-solving abilities in real-time scenarios. For students in computing disciplines, onsite exposure significantly enhances practical competence and industry readiness.

3.2 Objective of the Internship

The main aim of this internship was to have a practical exposure of managing enterprise IT infrastructure and cyber-security operations in organized banking set-up. The internship was meant to remove a difference between knowledge in books and its application in a real life financial institution.

The following were specific objectives:

- Knowledge of domain-based network environments and central administrative IT.
- Hardware and software life cycle management in the banking business.
- Configuration and installation and troubleshooting of learning systems.
- Elucidating on security controls, access management and threat monitoring mechanisms.
- Learning about Data backup confirmation and business continuity.
- Improving analytical, technical documentation and professional communication proficiency.

The purpose of this internship was to give exposure to the industry per the industry standards, as well as technical depth.

3.3 Overview of the Organization

This internship was completed at the IT Hub of Askari Bank. The IT department is responsible for managing centralized infrastructure, maintaining secure connectivity between branches, administering domain-controlled environments, and ensuring the protection of sensitive financial data.

The department oversees hardware deployment, software configuration, user account management, network resource allocation, and implementation of cyber-security policies. It also monitors system performance, handles incident response procedures, and verifies data backup processes to maintain operational continuity.

During my internship, I worked within this professional environment and observed how structured IT governance, layered security mechanisms, and standardized operating procedures ensure secure and efficient banking operations across multiple branches.

4. Internship Details

4.1 Duration and Timeline

The internship at the IT Hub of Askari Bank was conducted onsite over a period of **6 weeks**, starting from **January 19, 2026**, to **February 27, 2026**.

I dedicated approximately **6–7 hours per day**, adhering to the bank's standard working schedule, and actively participated in both operational tasks and project-based assignments on a weekly basis.

A weekly breakdown of tasks included infrastructure setup, software configuration, data backup verification, branch IT administration, and project assignments such as front-end website development, SRS documentation, and Excel-based analytical scenarios.

4.2 Nature of Work

The internship involved practical exposure to IT operations and cyber-security practices in a banking environment. The key services and projects undertaken included:

- **IT Infrastructure Management:** Installation, configuration, and troubleshooting of hardware and software across the IT Hub and branch offices.
- **Network Administration:** Domain-based network management, user account setup, access control, and branch connectivity monitoring.
- **Cyber-security Operations:** Monitoring unauthorized access attempts, verifying data backups, assisting in implementing layered security measures, and understanding firewall and antivirus deployment.
- **Software and Analytical Tasks:** Development of a front-end website (basic to advanced), preparation of a Software Requirements Specification (SRS) document, and solving Excel-based scenarios using formulas, pivot tables, conditional formatting, and dashboard creation.
- **IT Infrastructure Management:** Installation, configuration, and troubleshooting of hardware and software across the IT Hub and branch offices.
- **Administrative Support:** Setting up email accounts, configuring Microsoft Outlook.

These tasks provided hands-on experience in both technical and administrative aspects of banking IT operations.

4.3 Client Interaction

Although the internship was primarily onsite and internal within the bank, client interaction involved:

- Communicating with branch staff to understand technical issues and ensure smooth IT operations.
- Collaborating with team members to coordinate project assignments and task completions.
- Reporting progress and submitting weekly assignments to supervisors for feedback.

This exposure enhanced my professional communication, teamwork, and client-focused problem-solving skills in a corporate environment.

4.4 Tools & Technologies Used

During the internship, I gained practical experience with the following tools and technologies:

- **Development Tools:** HTML, CSS, JavaScript for front-end website development.
- **Networking & Administration:** Domain-based network management tools, Active Directory, backup verification utilities.
- **Cybersecurity & Monitoring:** Firewalls, antivirus software, access control monitoring systems.
- **Software & Applications:** Microsoft Excel (formulas, pivot tables, conditional formatting, dashboards), Microsoft Word, Microsoft Outlook, SRS documentation tools.
- **Communication Platforms:** Internal banking communication channels, emails, and meetings for task coordination.

5. Work Samples / Project Summaries

5.1 Front-End Website Development (Basic To Advance)

Client Requirements:

The External supervisor requested that a web based interface be developed to emulate a banking application both in practices and portfolios and have a clean layout, easily navigational, and easy to use design.

Approach and Tools Used:

- Front-end development has been done using HTML, CSS and JavaScript.
- Formatted sections namely, Home, About Us, Services, Contact and Internet Banking.
- Introduced interactive elements (i.e., Create Account, Let's Connect) and visual areas with pictures of the bank to make the user work more interactive.
- Developed a Software Requirements Specification (SRS) which was a formal record of system functionality, user interactions and interface design.

Outcomes Achieved:

- Created a working front-end prototype of layout design, responsive and efficient content hierarchy.
- A deeper appreciation of front-end good practices and user experience knowledge.
- SRS documentation helped to match development objectives to professional IT standards.

5.2 Software Requirements Specification (SRS) for Askari Bank Web System

Client Requirements:

In order to have requirements formalized to implement a web-based banking portal to facilitate organized planning to have the system in terms of its functionality, interaction with the users, and constraints to the operations of the system.

Approach and Tools Used:

- Created an SRS document based on non-functional and functional requirements.
- Specific system characteristics: user authentication, account management, digital banking instructions, account opening, corporate and Islamic banking modules and customer support.
- The following use cases are included account opening, contact support, browsing services, and user login.
- Certain technical limitations: browser support, security standards, responsive design and robust backend integration.
- Adhered to IEEE standards (830 and 29148) of structured documentation of software.

Outcomes Achieved:

- Gave a clear roadmap on front implementation.
- Ensured a common understanding of system scope and behavior among all stakeholders (supervisors and evaluators).
- Document is the professional tool in terms of improvements, testing, and operational implementation coming.
- IT Infrastructure monitoring system based on Excel.

5.3 Excel-Based IT Infrastructure Monitoring System

Client Requirements:

A case that was presented by the external Supervisor was that the IT Hub had to have a system that can monitor the IT assets of the branches such as ATMs, servers, biometric devices as well as the networking equipment. It was aimed at tracking the downtime and maintenance schedule, ages of devices and status of complaint resolution in order to facilitate proactive IT operations and decision making.

Approach and Tools Used:

- Prepared a centralized Excel master sheet that included all the branch level IT-based data, but with the following columns; Branch Name, Type of device, Device Id, Complaint status, hours of downtime, Last time of maintenance and age of a device.
- Analytical formulas used:
 - SUMIFS to obtain the cumulative downtime of each branch or type of device.
 - COUNTIFS to compute the pending complaints and maintenance due.
 - AND/OR logic IF to categorize the devices as Low, Medium, and High-risk in accordance with an established set of technical criteria.
 - DATE and TODAY is used to automatically mark bad maintenance.
- Created Pivot Tables to provide some important summaries of essential measures such as total downtimes per branch, complaints per device type and distribution of devices by their risk level.

Outcomes Achieved:

- Supported automatic monitoring of IT assets without review.
- Offered branch-wise and device-level learning, which enabled the resolution of problems faster.
- Better preventive maintenance and risk mitigation decision making.
- Minimized possible downtimes and increased operational performance within the branching.

6. Learning Experiences

a. Knowledge acquired:

My six weeks of internship with the IT Operations Team at Askari Bank enabled me to have a great insight into banking IT infrastructure that, arguably, supplemented my learning experience at the COMSATS University Islamabad. The ideas that I learned during my Computer Networks course were literally put into testing when I came across network equipment like switches, routers, firewalls and structured cabling that links different branches to central servers, explaining how data is safely transmitted over distance to the central servers. In the same vein, the concepts of Operating Systems were also reinforced with the practical skills of working with windows diagnostic commandments such as ipconfig and wmic bios, disk partitioning of a means of effective data management, and creating a Software Requirements Specification (SRS) of a web based bank system, which put the theories in the classroom to practical use in the form of a documented software requirement specification that is used in IT projects in the banking industry.

b. Skills learned:

The set of professional and technical skills I acquired during the internship can be directly applied to the field of IT and cybersecurity. Technically, I improved in Excel-based data management including sumifs, countsifs, if and and/or logic, date related functions, and pivot tables to track it infrastructure at the branch level. My front-end development was also developed with the use of HTML, CSS, and JavaScript, and provided me with experience with the preparation of Software Requirements Specification (SRS) which sharpened my skills in software documentation. At work, my analytical, problem-solving, and project planning skills have also become better as I completed tasks such as organizing IT data in the branch, creating dashboards, and handling tasks on a weekly basis. Also, expertise acquired at CUI courses that included database management, foundations of networking and concepts of software engineering would also be well-applied when familiarizing the fundamental banking systems and configurations, alongside monitoring systems within the internship.

c. Observed Attitudes and Gained Values

The internship helped me realize the professional values and attitudes that would make me successful in the IT career. I noted the significance of reliability, time keeping and responsibility, because timely check-ups and inspection were essential to the smooth economic running of the bank. The use of care during the handling of the IT hardware, software configuration, and checking of the integrity of backups was necessary. I also gained the importance of proactive problem-solving, teamwork, and effective communication since the coordination of IT staff at various branches had to be effectively reported and cooperate with one another. Such attitudes supported the role of professionalism, integrity, and commitment in a banking setting in a practical world.

d. The Most Challenging Task Performed

Design and implementation of the IT Infrastructure Monitoring System which is an Excel-based asset tracking and performance analysis was the most difficult assignment during my internship as the system needed to be overseen at the branch level. The work involved unifying large volumes of technical knowledge across various branches, and converting it into a system that would be structured to give alert to device downtime, maintenance delays, and threats to operations. On my part, I had developed a Role-Based Access Control (RBAC) model to emulate the authentications of users, role hierarchy, and permission-based access, based on the actual security experience of the bank. These two assignments were intensive in terms of planning, testing, and logical thinking, improving my analytical nature and its practicality in the field of cybersecurity and operations of IT.

7. Challenges Faced & Solutions

A major challenge during my internship at the IT Hub of Askari Bank was the strict security policy that prohibited taking screenshots within the banking environment. Due to this restriction, I was unable to capture visual evidence of critical systems such as Active Directory configurations, firewall monitoring dashboards, and Core Banking Client deployments observed during Weeks 1–6. This made it difficult to attach practical proof in my weekly reports as required.

To manage this limitation, I maintained comprehensive written notes, carefully documenting system processes, configurations, and observations in a clear and structured manner. This approach allowed me to prepare accurate and detailed reports while fully complying with the bank's security regulations.

Additionally, while working on Excel-based calculations such as downtime analysis, risk categorization, and overdue maintenance tracking .I initially faced errors due to complex nested formulas. I resolved this by breaking formulas into smaller logical steps, testing each part individually, and cross-verifying results to ensure accuracy. This systematic method improved both the reliability of my reports and my problem-solving skills.

8. Reflection & Conclusion

My six-week onsite internship at the IT Hub of Askari Bank was a highly valuable learning experience that bridged the gap between academic knowledge and practical IT operations. I worked on infrastructure monitoring across branches, Excel-based performance tracking, email and software configuration, frontend banking web development, and preparation of the Software Requirements Specification (SRS). These tasks allowed me to apply concepts from networking, operating systems, and software engineering studied at COMSATS University Islamabad, Abbottabad. The internship strengthened both my technical and professional skills, including time management, attention to detail, teamwork, and proactive problem-solving. I also developed a strong understanding of security compliance, discipline, and accountability within a banking environment. Overall, this experience clarified my career goals and motivated me to further specialize in IT infrastructure management and cybersecurity.

9. Appendices

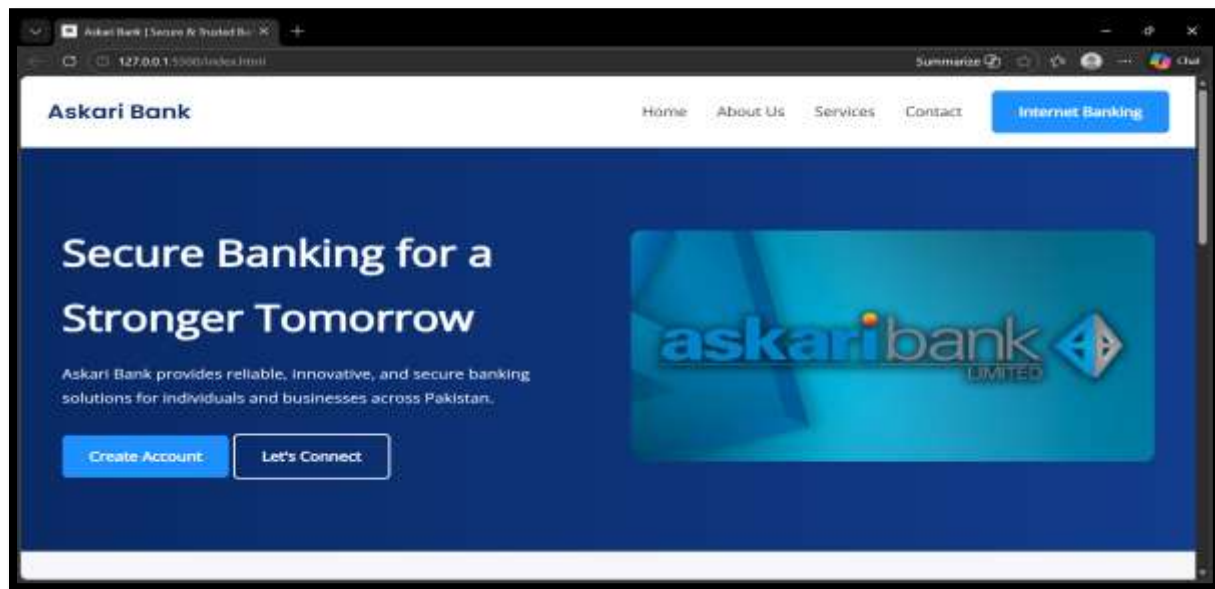
a. Appendix A (Hardware Interface)



Random Access Memory (RAM) module installed on the motherboard, responsible for temporarily storing data and instructions required for active system processes

b. Appendix B (Screenshots of Projects) PROJECT 1:

The basic Askari Bank frontend project was created and completed as the first internship task in Week 1. The interface includes responsive pages with login and registration forms and interactive elements to simulate user interactions. The demo was submitted to the supervisor team for evaluation.



PROJECT 2:

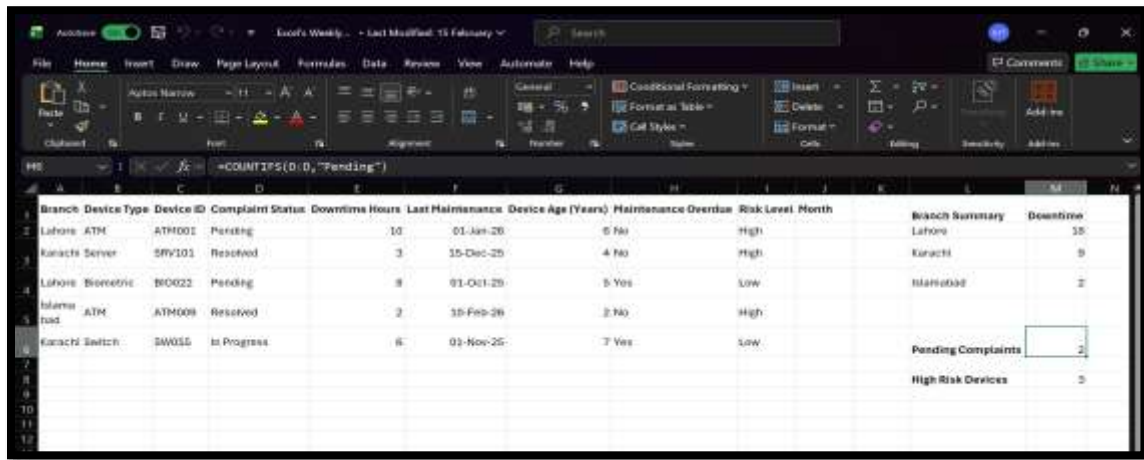
The advanced Askari Bank frontend project was developed as the second internship assignment in Week 2. This project focused on creating a more feature-rich and interactive banking interface with additional enhancements such as dynamic form validation, interactive dashboards, and improved responsive design. The completed advanced frontend project was shared with the supervisory team. In Week 3 of my internship at Askari Bank IT Hub, I prepared the Software Requirement Specification (SRS) document for this project. The document clearly defined the system's objectives, functional requirements, non-functional requirements, user roles, and system constraints.



CLICK HERE TO SEE THE WEBSITE: [LINK](#)

c. Appendix C (Microsoft Excel Tasks)

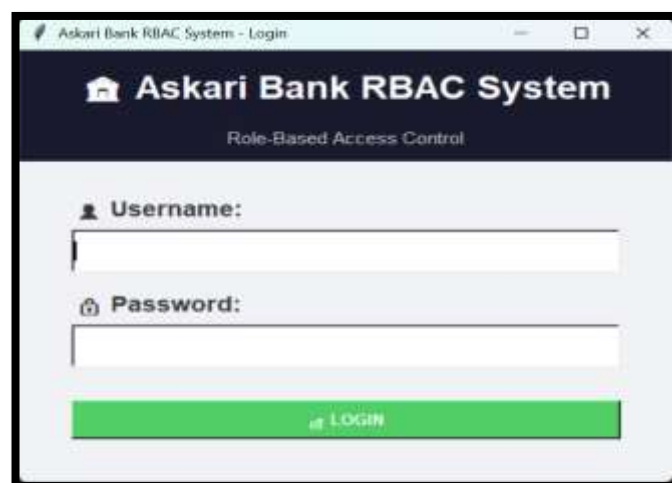
During Week 4 of my internship at Askari7 Bank IT Hub, I performed data analysis tasks using Microsoft Excel. I utilized formulas such as SUM, AVERAGE, IF, VLOOKUP, COUNT, COUNTIF, MAX and MIN to calculate totals, analyze records, apply conditions, and perform financial computations



Branch	Device Type	Device ID	Complaint Status	Downtime Hours	Last Maintenance	Device Age (Years)	Maintenance Overdue	Risk Level	Month
Lahore	ATM	ATM001	Pending	10	01-Jan-25	6 No	High		
Karachi	Server	Srv101	Resolved	3	15-Dec-24	4 No	High		
Lahore	Biometric	BIO022	Pending	8	01-Oct-25	5 Yes	Low		
Islamabad	ATM	ATM009	Resolved	2	10-Feb-26	3 No	High		
Karachi	Switch	SW055	In Progress	6	03-Nov-25	7 Yes	Low		
Pending Complaints									2
High Risk Devices									5

d. Appendix D (RBAC SYSTEM)

During my internship at Askari Bank **IT Hub**, I independently developed a Role-Based Access Control (RBAC) system to strengthen my understanding of cybersecurity and access management principles. This project was not assigned by my supervisor; rather, I took the initiative after observing how the bank implements role-based permission structures to protect sensitive financial and organizational data.



Askari Bank RBAC System - Login

Askari Bank RBAC System

Role-Based Access Control

Username:

Password:

LOGIN

10. INTERNSHIP LETTER



Ref No. AKBL/024/BB/03/2026

March 03, 2026.

CERTIFICATE OF INTERNSHIP.

This is to certify that Miss. **MAHEEN TOKIR D / O MUHAMMAD TOKIR** bearing CNIC # 34803 - 0453297 - 8 Resident of Mandian, Abbottabad was inducted as an internee at Askari Bank Ltd Abbottabad Branch with effect from January 19, 2026 for a period of six (6) weeks. During the course of training Miss. **MAHEEN TOKIR D / O MUHAMMAD TOKIR** was given an orientation towards the practical attributes to the IT department i.e. (Computer Networking, cybersecurity & operational workflow handling).

Her overall inclination towards learning the skill - based areas of banking and comprehension about the scope of work is clear and methodical. She showed strong technical skills and professional conduct.

We wish her every success in future endeavors.



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VP Branch Manager

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